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PREVIEW

FRIDAY
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Oakland Tribune

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A community trying to cope

D. ROSS CAMERON — Staff photos

KATRINA WEBB of Richmond (top photo), with Bishop Bob Jackson at her side, talks about her slain friend, Tanya Hill McCall, to the congregation at Acts Full Gospel Church in Oakland during a grief counseling session. Congregants (above) take part in services for Hill McCall during the same session. Prosecutors have charged Hill McCall's estranged husband with shooting her Sunday in the parking lot of the church, where she was a member. Marian Howard (below, speaking at the session) comforted Hill McCall during her last moments.

Restraining order no guarantee of safety

■ Hill McCall's slaying puts spotlight on weaknesses of law

By Paul T. Rosynsky
STAFF WRITER

OAKLAND — Tanya Hill McCall probably felt safe as she walked through the parking lot of Acts Full Gospel Church last Sunday toward her weekly retreat inside the East Oakland church.

The two decades' worth of abuse her husband, Matthew, had inflicted on her were coming to an end.

She had finally filed for divorce, left the house they shared and won a restraining order against him that ordered him to stay at least 100 yards away from her.

Yet, 20 minutes before she was to begin worship, police say she was gunned down by the man the law said should have been nowhere near her.

Please see **LAW,** News 7

Not Just A Number

ON THE WEB:
View our online feature on Oakland's homicide rate and hear audio clips from the church services at:
OaklandTribune.com

MY WORD: Bishop Bob Jackson calls for forgiveness.
Metro 9

Brenda PAYTON
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More to Oakland than homicide headlines

THE PAGES of this newspaper have been filled with tragedy and its aftermath over the past two weeks.

Last week we ran a series of stories about one murder last year and our annual map with the location and time of each homicide and photograph of the victim. Tragically, this week began with the shocking news that Tanya Hill McCall was gunned down in a church parking lot while she was on

Please see **PAYTON,** News 7

Church still rattled, grief-stricken after parishioner gunned down

By Kamika Dunlap
STAFF WRITER

OAKLAND — When Tanya Hill McCall was ambushed Sunday morning in a barrage of bullets, including one fired into her as she lay helpless on the pavement outside an East Oakland church, she saw the face of love before she died.

It was Marian Howard, a member of Hill McCall's Acts Full Gospel Church family who rushed to her side, acknowledged the pain in McCall's eyes and prayed with her.

"I tried to save her. She was crying and I turned her head to make her feel comfortable," Howard said. "It's my theory that if you are going to leave this world, you probably don't want to be alone."

Moments later, paramedics arrived and pronounced Hill McCall dead after frantic efforts to save her.

"Tears were rolling down her cheek when she died," Howard said. "I took my suit jacket off and I covered her up. That day changed my life."

Howard, a member of the church for six years, and her husband, a member for 12

Please see **GRIEF,** News 7

All eyes to be on Obama in Oakland's melting pot

PATRICK DeTEMPLE of Berkeley hands out free tickets in Oakland for Democratic presidential hopeful Barack Obama's upcoming campaign stop.

D. ROSS CAMERON — Staff

■ Candidate's race won't guarantee votes, locals say; downtown rally on Saturday

By Mary Anne Ostrom and Josh Richman
MEDIANEWS STAFF

When schoolteacher Mari Houssni-Adler went to Oakland's Jack London Square last weekend wearing a homemade "Obama 08" T-shirt, she turned heads.

"People were curious. They stopped me and seemed surprised that a middle-age white woman was supporting Barack Obama," the San Jose woman said.

Obama's run is challenging at least some racial stereotypes in politics, and his candidacy has reignited the discussion about whether an African American can be elected president.

Please see **OBAMA,** News 7

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Forecast

Mostly sunny
Highs: mid-60s
Lows: lower 50s

Details on **Business 8**